

LEON GAWENDA

Ph.D. Candidate and Research Associate
Bielefeld University (Faculty of Sociology)

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updated Mar 4, 2026

RESEARCH INTERESTS

My current research investigates spatial patterns of political participation and their history. I mainly use electoral data, survey data and quantitative methods to examine historical continuity and change in political behaviours and attitudes.

EDUCATION

Bielefeld University Sep 2024 – present

- Ph.D. candidate in Sociology, supervisor: Prof. Dr. Martin Kroh
- Research associate at the Leibniz Science Campus, SOEP RegioHub

Tübingen University 2021 – 2024

- M.A. Public Policy & Social Change (GPA: 1.1)
- stay abroad at Sciences Po, Aix-en-Provence (FR)
- Thesis: Environmental issue salience and policy support

Passau University 2017 – 2021

- B.A. Governance & Public Policy (GPA: 1.2)

CURRENT PROJECTS

Explaining continuity in Germany's electoral geography across 130 years
Working paper

Electoral and social-structural data of Imperial Germany
New data collection

Who speaks for the left-behind? Framing of spatial inequalities in parliamentary speeches
Working paper with Chen Zeng and Konstantin Wandel

Environmental issue salience and policy support
Working paper

CONFERENCES & WORKSHOPS

AK Wahlen Jahrestagung, Free University Berlin Sep 2025

EPOP Annual Conference 2025, Exeter University Sep 2025
Paper presentation

Workshop on Political Behaviour in Central and Eastern Europe, EUI Florence Jun 2025
Paper presentation

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Tübingen University

- Tutorial for "Methods of policy evaluation: panel analysis and quasi-experiments" (Graduate)
- Tutorial for "Introduction to quantitative analysis" (Undergraduate)

SKILLS

Statistical analysis R, Stata

Languages German, English, Spanish (B2), French (B1)